

## H/O – Bedmaking Checklist: Occupied & Unoccupied Bed

Day 8 | GA Healthcare Training & Consulting | Nurse Aide Training Program

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

### Why Bedmaking Is a Tested Skill

A wrinkle-free, dry, properly made bed is a pressure-injury prevention measure, not housekeeping. Making an occupied bed also appears on the Georgia Required Skills Checklist and must be checked off at 100% in the lab before you may attend clinical. Reference: Hartman's Nursing Assistant Care: The Basics, 6th Edition — occupied bed, pp. 209–210; unoccupied bed, p. 213.

### Unoccupied Bed — Procedure Steps

| Procedure Step                                                                    | Critical Point / Rationale                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Wash your hands and gather clean linen.                                        | Stack linen in the order of use so the bottom sheet is on top of the pile.    |
| 2. Carry linen away from your uniform.                                            | Linen touching your uniform is considered contaminated.                       |
| 3. Put on gloves if the bed linen is soiled.                                      | Standard Precautions apply to all body fluids.                                |
| 4. Raise the bed to a comfortable working height and lock the wheels.             | Protects your back; prevents the bed from rolling.                            |
| 5. Place the bed flat and lower the side rails.                                   | Gives you a level surface to work on.                                         |
| 6. Loosen soiled linen and roll it away from you, dirty side inward.              | Never shake linen — shaking spreads microorganisms through the air.           |
| 7. Place soiled linen in the hamper or laundry bag.                               | Never place linen on the floor, on a chair, or on another resident's bed.     |
| 8. Remove and discard gloves; wash your hands.                                    | Do not touch clean linen with soiled gloves.                                  |
| 9. Place the mattress pad and bottom sheet, center fold at the middle of the bed. | Centering keeps the sheet even on both sides.                                 |
| 10. Miter the corners at the head and the foot; tuck in tightly.                  | A wrinkle-free surface helps prevent pressure injuries.                       |
| 11. Add the draw sheet if used; tuck in on both sides.                            | The draw sheet is used to move and turn the resident.                         |
| 12. Place the top sheet, blanket, and bedspread; center each one.                 | Hem side of the top sheet faces up, seams away from the resident's skin.      |
| 13. Make a toe pleat and miter the corners at the foot.                           | The pleat gives the feet room and helps prevent foot drop and skin breakdown. |
| 14. Put a clean case on the pillow.                                               | Never hold the pillow under your chin — that contaminates it.                 |
| 15. Return the bed to its lowest position.                                        | A low bed is the single most important fall precaution.                       |
| 16. Wash your hands.                                                              | Ends every procedure.                                                         |

### Occupied Bed — Procedure Steps

| Procedure Step                                                                                                 | Critical Point / Rationale                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Wash your hands and gather clean linen.                                                                     | Bring everything you need before you start; never leave the resident to fetch linen. |
| 2. Identify the resident and greet him or her by name.                                                         | Confirms you have the right resident and shows respect.                              |
| 3. Explain what you are going to do before you begin.                                                          | Keep the resident informed throughout the entire procedure.                          |
| 4. Provide privacy — curtain, door, and window shades.                                                         | Privacy is a Residents' Right, not a courtesy.                                       |
| 5. Put on gloves.                                                                                              | Bottom linen may be soiled with body fluids.                                         |
| 6. Raise the bed to a safe working height and lock the wheels.                                                 | Never leave the resident alone with the bed raised.                                  |
| 7. Lower the head of the bed flat if the resident can tolerate it.                                             | Stop and reposition if the resident has trouble breathing.                           |
| 8. Cover the resident with a bath blanket and remove the top sheet from underneath.                            | Keeps the resident warm and covered; prevents exposure.                              |
| 9. Raise the side rail on the far side of the bed.                                                             | The raised rail keeps the resident from rolling off while turned away from you.      |
| 10. Loosen the bottom linen on your side and turn the resident toward the far rail.                            | Adjust the pillow under the head after turning.                                      |
| 11. Roll the soiled bottom linen toward the resident's back, soiled side inward.                               | Rolling inward contains the contamination.                                           |
| 12. Place clean bottom linen on the empty half; miter, tuck, and fanfold the rest against the resident's back. | Smooth every wrinkle — the resident is lying on this surface.                        |
| 13. Raise your side rail, move to the other side, and lower that rail.                                         | Both rails are never down at the same time with a resident in the bed.               |
| 14. Help the resident roll over the linen toward you onto the clean side.                                      | Tell the resident there will be a bump under the hip.                                |
| 15. Remove the soiled linen and place it in the hamper or bag.                                                 | Do not shake; do not let it touch your uniform.                                      |
| 16. Pull the clean linen through, smooth it, miter, and tuck.                                                  | Check for wrinkles one more time before repositioning.                               |
| 17. Reposition the resident on the back in good body alignment.                                                | Use pillows and supports as directed by the care plan.                               |
| 18. Place the clean top sheet over the bath blanket, then pull the bath blanket out from underneath.           | The resident is never uncovered during the change.                                   |
| 19. Make a toe pleat; miter the corners at the foot.                                                           | Loose top linen prevents pressure on the toes.                                       |
| 20. Change the pillowcase, supporting the resident's head.                                                     | Support the head and neck the whole time.                                            |
| 21. Remove gloves and wash your hands.                                                                         | Remove gloves before touching clean surfaces.                                        |
| 22. Lower the bed, place the call light within reach, and open the curtain.                                    | Side rails up only if the care plan directs it.                                      |
| 23. Report and record what you observed.                                                                       | Report skin changes, drainage, incontinence, or pain right away.                     |

## Bed Types — Know the Difference

| Bed Type                | When It Is Used                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Closed bed              | Bedspread pulled all the way up over the pillow. Used when the room is empty or a new resident has not yet arrived. |
| Open bed                | Top linens fanfolded down to the foot. Used when the resident is about to get back into bed.                        |
| Occupied bed            | Made while the resident stays in the bed. Used when the resident cannot get up.                                     |
| Surgical (recovery) bed | Top linens fanfolded to one side, bed left flat and raised. Used to receive a resident arriving on a stretcher.     |

## Lab Skills Check-Off

| Required Skill                                   | Lab Practicum Sign-Off            |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Making an unoccupied bed — Hartman 6e, p. 213    | Instructor initials / date: _____ |
| Making an occupied bed — Hartman 6e, pp. 209–210 | Instructor initials / date: _____ |

## Reflection

Name two things you would do differently if the resident began coughing while turned onto one side.